theoretical underpinning deprives WSA of a sound foundation. On the other hand, reconsideration of WSA from the perspective of the surplus value approach makes it a powerful tool of analysis of the modern world.

Working along the lines of Marxian methodology, the modern Russian school of critical Marxism was developed at Moscow State University, the Academy of Sciences and a number of other universities. It focuses on different features of the political economy of dependent development peculiar to modern Russia, with a focus on class interests and class conflicts shaping social change in modern Russia.

Genesis of modern Russian capitalism

The deficiency of the mainstream account of so-called 'transition' is its purely technical approach to market reforms, lacking any account of the social, class interests as their major driving forces. There are two principal formative forces which shaped modern Russian capitalism: the degeneration of the Stalinist bureaucracy and the impact of global financialised capitalism. The first manifested itself in growing privileges and informal command over resources, giving private gains on the basis of state property. The second manifested itself in the growing dependence of the core capitalist countries on exploitation of the periphery of the world system, with financial capital increasingly replacing productive capital. In the course of the radical market reforms of the early 1990s these two factors mixed to produce nascent capitalism in Russia. From the standpoint of WSA, Russia belongs to the semi-periphery, which, on the one hand, is dependent on the core, but, on the other, aspires to control its own regional periphery in the area of the former USSR.

Big business and the deficient accumulation of capital in Russia

To give an account of Russian capitalism as a social system, one needs to define the concrete form of surplus value characteristic of this society. Such an approach provides an opportunity to use the logic of capital, where all major economic relations are derived from the notion of surplus value. The present chapter argues that the main features of modern Russian capitalism, including its accumulation of capital, pattern of development, political system and position in the world economy and in the system of international relations, can be explained from the perspective of the concrete of surplus value. The latter is treated as the dominant social interest shaping all aspects of Russian capitalism.

The specific Russian model of corporate governance (which is a euphemism meaning the methods of capitalist control over assets) is of an authoritarian